

CELEBRATING THE ETERNAL BUDDHA

Bodh Gaya, will come alive with the three-day cultural celebrations as part of the grand Bodh Mahotsav, to be held from 19th to 21st January, 2024, at Kalchakra ground, Bodh Gaya. The world's biggest annual holy festival of the Buddhist, started in 1998, is being jointly organized by the Bodh Gaya Temple Management Committee, Gaya district administration and the department of tourism, Bihar government. The event echoes a commitment towards preserving and showcasing the cultural heritage of Bihar embedded in these historical sites. The monuments and artifacts serve as living testaments to a bygone era, carrying stories of spiritual enlightenment and historical evolution. By actively promoting the significance of these areas, Bihar Tourism contributes to the conservation of the Buddhist Circuit.

Bodh Gaya, an integral stop on the Buddhist circuit, follows the Buddha's transformative journey from Lumbini to Uttar Pradesh. Noteworthy sites include, UNESCO-listed Mahabodhi Temple, and the ancient Bodhi Tree. This sacred pilgrimage, drawing four million visitors yearly, unveils the profound roots of Buddhism. The circuit encompasses Nalanda, the first residential university, Rajgir's serene landscapes, and Griddhakuta Hill, where the Buddha delivered pivotal sermons. Vaishali, with its Relic Stupa, echoes history, while Lauria, Nandangarh and Kesaria boast colossal stupas. Vikramshila University's ruins in Bhagalpur, underline Bihar's cultural grandeur during the Pala dynasty.

The Mahabodhi Temple, constructed by Emperor Asoka in the third century B.C. and an attraction for approximately four million annual visitors, stands as a testament to enduring devotion. The Bodhi Tree, a venerable fig tree with a history spanning 2600 years, located within the Mahabodhi temple complex, remains a significant pilgrimage center for Buddhists worldwide. The Bodh Mahotsav, inaugurated in 1998, stands as a tribute to the Buddha's teachings and the cultural traditions emanating from them.

This cultural spectacle unfolds as a global stage for the convergence of diverse cultures, fostering unique experiences that cultivate human connections within a festive milieu. The festivities encompass animated performances, vibrant parades, and an art and craft mela, showcasing a rich tapestry of both traditional and contemporary artistic expressions. Reports indicate the active involvement of the television and film industries, adding a touch of glamour to the event. The collective endeavors create an atmosphere akin to a carnival, where the celebratory spirit becomes a catalyst for fostering camaraderie and shared cultural appreciation on a global scale.

This year's Mahotsav assumes heightened significance with the presence of His Holiness, the Dalai Lama, accentuating the profound spiritual and cultural dimensions of his participation. The festival serves as a distinguished platform for scholarly discussions, seminars, and intellectual exchanges centered around the tenets of Buddhism. Seekers and scholars from diverse corners of the globe converge in the sacred environs of Gaya, facilitated by the city's accessibility through well-established rail, road, and air networks.





The Bodh Mahotsav promises an enticing gastronomic spectacle, featuring food stalls and dining establishments offering delectable local and international cuisines. Traditionally, Bodh Gaya has global tourists, especially from the South East Asian countries, many of whom have built temples in their native architecture which standout in the landscape with their colourful pagodas, an attraction in themselves. The culmination of these elements renders the Bodh Gaya Mahotsav a holistic and immersive celebration, inviting participants to explore the confluence of spirituality, history, and cultural diversity in this sacred land.

The Bihar Tourism Department is dedicated to creating an extraordinary and enriching experience with the Bodh Mahotsav. This event invites the world to discover Bihar's unique fusion of spirituality, history, and ethos. The festival offers a chance to immerse oneself in a vibrant tapestry of culture and tradition, showcasing the state's warm hospitality. Bodh Mahotsav welcomes visitors to explore a land steeped in heritage, extending open arms to all seeking a profound and unforgettable journey into the heart of India's cultural richness.